

Setup Guide

RMC Formation · Training LLMs at Scale + Research with Agents

This covers accounts and tools on **your laptop**. The cluster's Python/conda environment is set up separately in Session 1.

At a glance

#	What	For	When
1	Weights & Biases account	Experiment tracking	Day 1
2	Hugging Face account + write token	Models, datasets, Hub	Day 1
3	GitHub account	Cloning exercises, version control	Both days
4	Anthropic API key (free credit)	Claude Code agent	Day 2
5	OpenAI / ChatGPT account	Codex agent	Day 2
6	VS Code + extensions	Editor / remote dev	Both days
7	Node.js 18+, Git, agent CLIs	Running the agents	Day 2

1–3. Accounts

- **Weights & Biases** — free account at <https://wandb.ai>. Copy your key from <https://wandb.ai>/authorize; you'll paste it on the cluster.
- **Hugging Face** — free account at <https://huggingface.co/join>. Create a **Write** token at <https://huggingface.co/settings/tokens> (needed to push checkpoints). Save it — it's shown once.
- **GitHub** — free account at <https://github.com/signup> if you don't have one.

4. Anthropic API key — Claude Code (free)

1. Sign up at <https://console.anthropic.com>.
2. Create an API key under **API Keys**. **Do not add a payment method** — new accounts include free trial credit, which covers our light Day-2 usage.
3. Copy the key (`sk-ant-...`) and keep it private.

5. OpenAI / ChatGPT — Codex (free)

Codex signs in with a **free ChatGPT account** — create one at <https://chatgpt.com> if needed. No API key or payment required.

Never commit keys to git or share them. We'll set them as environment variables on Day 2.

6. VS Code

Install from <https://code.visualstudio.com>. Add these extensions on **both your laptop and the cluster** (Remote-SSH doesn't sync them):

Mandatory

- Remote - SSH (+ Remote Explorer) — connect to the cluster
- Python (extension pack)
- Jupyter

Nice to have

- GitLens, Black Formatter, Flake8, autoDocstring, Python Indent, Python Type Hint, Code Spell Checker, Rainbow CSV

Cursor (<https://cursor.com>) works too — same extensions and Remote-SSH flow. We'll demo in VS Code.

7. Node.js, Git, and the agent CLIs

The agent CLIs install via npm, so you need **Node.js 18+** (<https://nodejs.org> or `nvm`) and **Git** (<https://git-scm.com>). Then:

```
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code@latest    # Claude Code
npm install -g @openai/codex                      # Codex
```

We'll sign both in together on Day 2. Don't use `sudo` with npm — if you hit permission errors, install Node via `nvm`.

Pre-Day-1 smoke check

Each command should print a version with no error:

```
node --version    # v18+
git --version
code --version
claude --version
codex --version
```

And have these saved, ready to paste: **W&B key**, **HF write token**, **Anthropic key**. That's it — see you Day 1.